make the solar panels from?

Amma: Let me explain for you to understand. Silicon, extracted from sand, a natural resource, is used in making PV cells. These convert solar energy into electrical energy.

Kuzhali: Natural resource, what do you mean by it?

Amma: All things useful to man is resource. And if it is directly from nature we call it natural resource.

Kuzhali: Then what kind of work is Appa doing?

Amma: He is a manufacturer. He uses natural resources for manufacturing.

Kuzhali: Then, manufactured things be called as resources?

Amma: Yes, they are called as man made resources.

Kuzhali: Ok amma. It's getting late. Let me get ready.

Activity: 1

Circle the resources that are not necessary for gardening. Soil, Seeds, A piece of Land, Computers, Saplings, Flower Pots, Manure, Textbooks.

Resource is anything that fulfills human needs. When anything is of some use it becomes valuable. All resources have **value**. The value can be either **commercial** or **non-commercial**. **Commercial resources** have great economic value. (e.g.) Petroleum. The **Non-commercial resources** are very abundant in availability (e.g.) Air.

HOTS:

Do all the items in your shopping list have commercial value?



Anything becomes a resource only when its use is discovered. The needs of human beings are ever changing. According to the ever changing needs, resources keep changing. **Time** and **Technology** are two important factors that determine whether a substance is a resource or not. for example: Sun's energy to generate electricity was made possible after the invention of solar panels (technology); and the receding of coal and petrol was in need of an inexhaustible resource (time).



HOTS:

Is the tilt of the solar panels same everywhere on Earth?

Resources can be **natural**, **man-made** and **human resources**.

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